

Transportation

The products of industry are used worldwide, thanks to efficient transportation networks that allow international trade. These networks also enable people to travel anywhere on the globe. Along with communications networks, power supplies, and water and drainage systems, transportation is part of the infrastructure of modern civilization.



SHIPPING

Shipping routes are among the oldest of all trade routes. The first sea traders stayed close to the coast so they knew where they were, but by 1000 BCE Phoenician traders were criss-crossing the Mediterranean Sea. Ships are still the best means of transporting heavy goods, and powerful engines and satellite navigation have greatly reduced the risks of long sea voyages.

▲ OCEAN TRADER
Stacked high with containers, each as large as a truck, this ship can carry a huge cargo between continents.

FACT!

Air travel has become so popular that, at any time of day or night, there are now half a million people flying through the world's skies.



INLAND WATERWAYS

Canal networks link many major cities. They were vital to the growth of industry, carrying coal and raw materials. Barges such as this one in Germany still carry heavy freights efficiently. They are slow, but this doesn't matter if a fleet of barges can deliver a continuous stream of cargo to its destination.

